FightIQ Weekly Guide

How to run the UFC model each fight week, read the picks, and track results. Written for a Mac.

The short version. Close Excel, open Terminal from GitHub Desktop, run **`python3 -m fightiq workbook --upcoming`**, then open the workbook. The card, odds, picks, bet suggestions and tracking all fill in by themselves. Last week's results fill in on the next run.

1. One-time setup

Most of this is done already. The only new step is the free odds key.

1. Python is installed and the code is cloned with GitHub Desktop to **Documents/GitHub/FightIQ** (branch **claude/confident-euler-i3nj2j**).
2. In GitHub Desktop, click **Repository > Open in Terminal**, then install the helpers and train the model:

```
pip3 install -r requirements.txt
python3 -m fightiq train
```

3. **Odds key (free):** sign up at **the-odds-api.com** (free plan: 500 requests a month; FightIQ uses 1 per run). Copy the key from their email and save it:

```
python3 -m fightiq odds-key PASTE_YOUR_KEY_HERE
```

2. Every fight week (Thursday or Friday)

1. **Save and close** the workbook in Excel if it is open.
2. In **GitHub Desktop**, click **Fetch origin**. If it then shows **Pull origin**, click it (that downloads any updates).
3. Click **Repository > Open in Terminal**.
4. Run the weekly command:

```
python3 -m fightiq workbook --upcoming
```

This refreshes every fighter's stats, loads the next UFC card from ufcstats.com, fills in the best current odds from Australian bookmakers, logs every pick into the Tracking tab, and fills in W/L for earlier bouts. It takes about a minute. A Chrome window may open for a few seconds: leave it, it closes itself.

5. Open the workbook:

```
open output/FightIQ_Model.xlsx
```

6. On the **Predictor** tab, check the card. Any bout with blank odds (columns C and D) was not listed by the odds service yet: type the **decimal** odds in yourself. Hover over an odds cell to see which bookmaker had that price.
7. Read the **Pick**, **FightIQ P(A)** and **Bet** columns (see section 4).
8. **If you typed or changed any odds:** press Cmd+S, close Excel, and run this so they are logged in Tracking:

```
python3 -m fightiq workbook
```

9. **Optional, on fight day:** update to the latest prices without changing the card:

```
python3 -m fightiq workbook --refresh-odds
```

3. After the event

- Nothing to do on the night. The next weekly run fills in **W / L** for every logged bout once the results are in the data (usually within a day or two of the event).
- Bouts that were scrapped are marked **Cancelled** and do not count towards the record or ROI.
- The top of the **Tracking** tab shows the running record, hit rate, units staked, profit and ROI.

4. Reading the Predictor

Column	What it means
Fighter A / B, Odds A / B	The bout and the decimal odds for each fighter (yellow cells are inputs).
Model P(A)	Chance Fighter A wins from the stats alone.
Market P(A)	The bookmakers' chance for Fighter A, with their margin removed.
FightIQ P(A)	The blend of the model and the market. This is the number to use when you have odds.
Pick / Pick prob.	The fighter FightIQ favours and how likely it rates them to win.
Bet / Bet odds / EV	A bet is suggested only when expected value (EV) is above 5% and neither fighter is making their UFC debut.
Stake (% bankroll)	Suggested stake: a quarter of the Kelly amount, never more than 2% of bankroll.
Notes	Flags names it can't find in the Fighters tab (misspelling or a debutant).

Typing fighters by hand: capitals don't matter (*jim miller* = *Jim Miller*) but the spelling must match the **Fighters** tab, with plain letters and no accents. American odds: +150 = 2.50, -200 = 1.50.

5. The Tracking tab

Column	Filled by
Date, Event, Fight, Pick, FightIQ prob.	Automatically, for every bout that has odds
Bet on, Bet odds, Stake (units)	Automatically, when a bet is suggested. 1 unit = 1% of bankroll.
Pick result, Bet result	Automatically after the event: W, L, D (draw), NC (no contest) or Cancelled
Pick correct, Bet profit	Excel formulas

- Until a bout is settled, each run refreshes its row with the latest odds and pick. Settled rows never change.
- You can add your own rows (W / L by hand). They are kept on every rebuild.
- Delete any row you don't want counted. The Figueiredo vs Talbott example row is removed automatically.

6. Keep your file safe

- **Always close Excel before running a command.** If Excel still has the old file open and you save it, the old version overwrites the new one.
- Keep the workbook where it is: **FightIQ/output/FightIQ_Model.xlsx**. Don't rename or move it, or the weekly run won't find your Tracking rows.
- Every run saves a copy of the previous file in **output/backup**.
- The output folder is not uploaded to GitHub. Copy the workbook to iCloud or OneDrive now and then.

7. Once a month

- Refit the model on the newest fights: **`python3 -m fightiq train`**
- After pulling updates in GitHub Desktop, run **`pip3 install -r requirements.txt`** once in case the update needs a new helper.

8. If something goes wrong

You see	Do this
couldn't find the next event on ufcstats.com	ufcstats blocked the automatic read. In Chrome, open the event's page on ufcstats.com (the one listing the bouts), press Cmd+S, choose **Webpage, HTML Only**, save to Downloads. Then type **`python3 -m fightiq workbook --event-html`** (with a space), drag the saved file into Terminal, and press Enter.
no odds API key saved	Save your key: **`python3 -m fightiq odds-key YOUR_KEY`**
monthly quota is used up	Type the odds in yourself; the free quota resets each month.
no odds yet for A vs B	The odds service hasn't listed that bout yet: type its odds in, or run --refresh-odds later.
can't write ... close it in Excel	Close the workbook in Excel and run the command again.
Notes: *name* not in Fighters	Check the spelling in the Fighters tab (Cmd+F). If they have never fought in the UFC, it's a debut: no bet is suggested.
command not found: python3	Open a new Terminal window from GitHub Desktop; if it persists, reinstall Python from python.org.
Results not filling in a week later	The fight-results data may be running behind. Send Claude a screenshot of the Terminal output.

Command cheat sheet

Command	What it does
`python3 -m fightiq workbook --upcoming`	Weekly: next card, odds, tracking, results
`python3 -m fightiq workbook`	Keep the card; refresh stats, log typed odds, fill results
`python3 -m fightiq workbook --refresh-odds`	Keep the card; update the odds
`python3 -m fightiq workbook --event-html FILE`	Card from a page saved in Chrome
`python3 -m fightiq odds-key KEY`	Save your odds key (once)
`python3 -m fightiq train`	Refit the model (monthly)
`open output/FightIQ_Model.xlsx`	Open the workbook

A reminder on staking. The backtest edge comes from historical odds whose timing isn't documented, so treat it as promising rather than proven. Keep stakes small (the sheet caps them at 2%) and let the Tracking tab build a live record before sizing up.